creation of an unintelligent or blind power, or a methodical evolution of the inherent energy of some unconscious root matter, or *prakṛti.* In other words, Indian philosophical thought is not at all sympathetic to any naturalistic or purely materialistic interpretation of the universe in which we live. This has been one of the deeper currents of thought, the materialistic or the agnostic trends in the Indian history of thought notwithstanding.

Along with the belief in the divine or the spiritual nature of the universe in which we live, necessarily goes the belief in the ultimate moral order of the universe. We do not think that there is a lack of moral authority or law in the universe or that we could do whatever we liked without reaping the just consequences of our actions. This is what is popularly known as the inexorable law of *dharma* or *karma.* Corresponding to the law of cause and effect in the world of nature, we think and believe that in the world of human affairs and actions too, there obtains not merely a law of cause and effect but also a law of moral justice, according to which reward and punishment are ultimately meted out to us, and from which there is no escape, either in this life or in the hereafter.

And now, it will not be difficult to show that in reality it is impossible either to demonstrate the reality of these beliefs in the actual existing world, or to philosophically prove them by arguments. Neither the divine nature of the universe nor the moral nature of the world stands philosophically proved or established by any one of our philosophical systems, though they are believed in by all the orthodox systems. In fact, these happen to be the most fundamental and common beliefs of all the Hindus. It is, therefore, only proper to call these and other such beliefs the religious beliefs rather than the philosophical tenets of Indian philosophy. The same applies to our common belief regarding rebirth, transmigration of the soul, and the ultimate destiny, or the *mokṣa,* of the soul from the bondage of the material body. In our vast philosophical literature there is nowhere to be found any elaborate discussion or proof of the above. These truths (if they have the status of truths) or beliefs appear to have been taken for granted on the testimony of experts to whom they are supposed to have been revealed beyond doubt in their own direct and immediate experience. This incidentally, leads to a philosophical point of some importance. In Indian philosophical thought, testimony, or *śabda pramāṇa,* has been almost universally recognized as a valid means of proof. This has been a source of some puzzlement to some modern-minded philosophers who recognize only perception and inference as admissible means of knowledge. The